

CHRISTOPHER V. AYALA

(612) 417-5127 | chris.ayala12@gmail.com | www.linkedin.com/in/chrisvayala | github.com/ChrisVAyala90 | chrisvayala.me

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack technologist and cross-functional leader with 5+ years across engineering, product, and UX. Architected production AI systems and governance, led strategic research programs driving executive roadmaps, and designed intuitive, high-impact interfaces. Backed by dual master's degrees (Software Development and HCI), translates fluidly between technical architecture reviews and user-interview sessions to deliver measurable business results.

EXPERIENCE

Life360 (NASDAQ: LIF) San Mateo, CA
Senior AI Partner Engineer II July 2026 – Present

- Serve as a cross-functional forward deployed AI transformation partner, managing end-to-end technical relationships and co-developing production-grade agentic workflows integrated across business units.
- Establish systematic evaluation frameworks for deployed workflows to capture field signals for the AI Native Platform, delivering reusable patterns that accelerate subsequent deployments.
- Own build-versus-buy decisions across the AI-native vendor market — separating genuine capability from positioning — to steer investment toward the highest-leverage builds.
- Safeguard real-time location and family-relationship data for ~98M members, including minors — engineering data boundaries into every workflow from the first line, in partnership with Legal, Privacy, and Security.

DraftKings (NASDAQ: DKNG) Boston, MA
Senior Software Engineer, AI Platform Ops Jul 2025 – Jul 2026

- Owned the AI Ops function for an internal AI platform powering 2,000+ dev and prod workflows — ~18K automated executions/month (1.13M+ lifetime) across product, regulatory compliance, CX, analytics, and agent orchestration.
- Hardened security and cost governance across ~7,000 automations by defining an enterprise governance framework — a FinOps cost-benefit algorithm plus multi-agent audits of 1,900+ processes that surfaced bottlenecks and risks like credential leaks.
- Shipped an autonomous AI code-review verdict subsystem (29 PRs) that adjudicated ~86K reviews across 700+ repos, closing security gaps by verifying check execution before honoring verdicts.
- Achieved an 80% one-week resolution rate across 414 tickets and 23 AI SDLC epics through orchestrated agentic execution.

Senior Product Researcher, Platform Jul 2022 – Jul 2025

- Improved annual Deposit CSAT from 72.7% to 77.8% (+5.1 points) through refined research methods and detractor oversampling; identified a perceived-failure gap that shifted the roadmap to focus on error communication.
- Led “My Stat Sheet” from insight to launch — 30% engagement across 13M+ visits in year one, growing to ~46% across 21M+ visits in year two (+52% YoY engagement).
- Synthesized CSAT and player-safety data to expose credit-card deposit risk — the lowest-satisfaction deposit method (~66%) — informing the company's move away from credit-card funding.

U.S. Bank (NYSE: USB) Minneapolis, MN
Product (UX) Researcher, Assistant Vice President (AVP) Dec 2021 – Aug 2022

- Established a continuous product-intelligence workflow built on session replays and quantified behavioral signals, accelerating decision-making for teams shipping customer-facing financial tools.

Freelance Minneapolis, MN
UX Designer Jan 2021 – Aug 2021

- Redesigned digital experiences for Grand Casino Arena, Ananda Natural Medicine, and Feat Not Nation — turning multi-method research into design and technical specs that lifted patient bookings 46% and optimized flow for 20K+ monthly visitors.

EDUCATION

Boston University Boston, MA
Master of Science in Software Development - GPA 3.69 Jul 2023 - Jan 2025

DePaul University Chicago, IL
Master of Science with Distinction in Human Computer Interaction - GPA 3.93 Jul 2020 - Dec 2021

SKILLS

AI & Automation: LLMs, RAG, vector databases, agent orchestration, evals, LangChain, LangGraph, OpenAI, Anthropic, n8n

Engineering & Infrastructure: Python, TypeScript, SQL, Java, Bash, AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD

Leadership & Delivery: Stakeholder management, technical scoping, solution architecture, deployment ownership, user onboarding, cross-functional delivery